# Year 8 Admission Assessment: assessor booklet

For students applying to join **Year 8** (age 12 to 13 on 1 September). A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 6** (the end of primary school) and is the same age as a student starting Grade 7 (初一). The maths paper tests UK Year 7 content, so algebraic manipulation, operations with negative numbers, angle rules with parallel lines, probability as a number, and the median, mode and range **may not have been taught yet**. A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: the science paper tests UK Year 7 content, so read the science score with the NT notes in Section 5. Background, the English bands and the decision guide are in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

## 1. At a glance

| Order | Task | Minutes | Who leads | Materials | Notes |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Welcome | 2 | Assessor | Student paper, pencil, rubber, ruler | Script in Section 2 |
| 2 | Listening (paper pages 2 to 3) | 5 | Assessor reads the script twice | This booklet, Section 3.1 | A conversation: you read both voices. Can be done with a small group |
| 3 | Reading paper (pages 4 to 9) | 12 | Student works alone; assessor times | Clock or timer | Do not read the texts aloud |
| 4 | Writing (pages 10 to 11) | 10 | Student works alone | | Choose one of two tasks |
| 5 | Break | 3 to 5 | | Water | |
| 6 | Maths (pages 12 to 16) | 20 | Student; assessor may read questions aloud | No calculator, no protractor | Section A number problems, Section B word problems and pictures |
| 7 | Science (pages 17 to 19) | 8 | Student; assessor may read questions aloud | | |
| 8 | Interview, opening with sentence reading | 15 | Interviewer, 1:1 | `forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Record`, `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, a plain card | Sentence reading starts at **Level 7** (sentence 19) |
| | **Total** | **about 70** | | | Plus the parent conversation (about 15 minutes, separate) |

**Print for each candidate:** the Year 8 student paper (19 pages, A4), the interview record (Years 7 to 10), the sentence reading record, the parent conversation record and the candidate summary. **Print once per room:** this booklet and the sentence reading card (laminate it). The score summary (Section 6) can be copied, one per candidate.

## 2. Before you start

**Welcome script.** Say, in a calm, friendly voice:

> "Hello, I'm … . Welcome to our school. Today you will do some activities in English: listening, reading, writing, maths and science. Then we will have a chat. The activities help us get to know you and find the right support for you. Some questions are easy and some are hard. That is fine. Do your best, and it is OK if you cannot

answer everything. In maths and science I can read a question to you. In the English parts I cannot explain words, because we want to see your English. You can always ask me to say an instruction again. Do you have any questions?"

**Access rules** (the same in every year group; details in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 7)

| | **English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)** | **Maths and science** |
|---|---|---|
| Reading aloud | Read only what the script says. Do not explain words, translate or read the reading texts aloud. You may repeat instructions in English. | Read any question aloud in English, as often as asked, and point to the picture. |
| Chinese | Not used by staff. All answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0. | If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Mark the question **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Answers must be in English; an answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0. |
| Not yet taught | | If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics in the score summary. |

- **Extra time or a reader** for a known need is allowed; record it in the score summary.
- **Stopping.** The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. In the reading paper, Part C is meant to stretch: if the student is clearly stuck after Part B, let them stop and say "Thank you, that is fine." In writing, if the student cannot write in English, ask them to write any words they know, or a plan; do not score Chinese writing, but keep it. Never push a distressed student: take a break or stop, and record it.
- **Keeping the student at ease.** Explain the order of the morning and the break. Sit beside, not opposite, for the interview. Praise effort, not answers ("Thank you, you are working hard"). Do not show surprise at mistakes. Keep the timer out of the student's line of sight, and give a calm two-minute warning near the end of each timed part. Many Year 8 students have just left primary school: tell them the science has topics they may not have studied yet, and that this is expected.

## 3. English

### 3.1 Listening (5 minutes, 8 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Listening page. I am going to read a conversation between two students, Mei and Amir. I will read it two times. First, read the questions." Give the student **one minute** to look at all eight questions (pages 2 and 3). Then say: "Now listen. You can answer while I read."

**Read it twice at a natural, steady pace.** You read both parts. Say the speaker's name before each turn, a little more quietly, and make the two voices slightly different. Pause for about 3 seconds at each [pause]. After the first reading, say "Now listen again" and read it again. After the second reading, give one minute to finish. Do not repeat any part, and do not explain any word.

**Script: Mei and Amir talk about the charity fair**

**Amir:** Mei, have you decided what our class is going to sell at the charity fair?

**Mei:** Yes! We wanted to sell cakes, but the Year 9 classes are already doing that. So we're going to sell plants instead: small ones, in pots. **[pause]**

**Amir:** Plants? OK. When is the fair? Is it this Friday?

**Mei:** No, it's next Saturday, from ten in the morning until two in the afternoon. **[pause]**

**Amir:** And where is our stall? Next to the music stage again?

**Mei:** No. Last year it was so loud there that nobody could hear us. This year we're by the main gate. **[pause]**

**Amir:** What can I do to help?

**Mei:** Can you make the price signs? You're much better at drawing than me. And Ms Chen says every class needs its own table. Can you bring one?

**Amir:** Sure. I'll do the signs this weekend, and I'll ask my dad about a table. He's got a folding one at home. **[pause]**

**Mei:** Thank you!

**Amir:** Where will we get the plants?

**Mei:** My aunt has a flower shop. She'll give us forty plants for 200 yuan. **[pause]**

**Amir:** And how much will we sell them for?

**Mei:** Ten yuan each. If we sell all of them, we'll get 400 yuan. After we pay my aunt, there will be 200 yuan for the charity. **[pause]**

**Amir:** Great. Oh, but I can only come in the morning. I have a piano lesson at one o'clock. **[pause]**

**Mei:** That's fine. And I'm really happy about the main gate.

**Amir:** Me too. Everybody will walk past us when they come in!

**Answers.** One mark each. Spelling does not matter if the meaning is clear. Answers must be in English.

| Q | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept, and what it tells you |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | **B** plants | | A (cakes): heard "cakes" but missed "but the Year 9 classes are already doing that". |
| 2 | **C** 2:00 | | A (10:00) is the start; B (1:00) is Amir's piano lesson. |
| 3 | **B** (by the main gate) | | A: last year's place, next to the music stage. |
| 4 | **Both** make the price signs **and** bring a table | | One correct only, or three or more ticked: 0. "Buy the plants" (the aunt gives them) and "play the piano" (his lesson) are distractors. |
| 5 | **40** | forty | 200 (the cost). |
| 6 | **200** | 200 yuan, ¥200 | 400: heard the takings but not "after we pay my aunt". |
| 7 | He has a piano lesson at one o'clock (and the fair goes on until two). | He has a piano lesson; he has to go to piano. | "He is drawing the signs"; "He is busy" with no reason. |
| 8 | Everybody walks past the main gate when they come in, so more people will see the stall. | It is not next to the music stage, so it is quieter and people can hear them; more customers. | "Because it is near the gate" with no reason; "because it is big". |

**Band guide (listening, / 8):** 0 to 2 **A** · 3 to 4 **B** · 5 to 6 **C** · 7 **D** · 8 **E**

**What to look for**

- Questions 1 to 4 each have a distractor that is mentioned in the conversation. Choosing the distractor every time shows a listener catching single words, not following the exchange: typical of band B.
- Question 6 needs the student to hear a correction ("after we pay my aunt"); questions 7 and 8 need inference across two turns. A fluent Year 8 listener answers both quickly.
- **English barrier or something else?** A conversation is harder than a single speaker because the student must track who says what. If a student scores low here but understood you well in conversation, note it and compare with the interview.

## 3.2 Reading paper (12 minutes, 24 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Reading pages. Read the texts and answer the questions. There are three parts. They get harder. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 12 minutes." Start the timer. Do not read the texts or questions aloud, and do not explain words. You may repeat this instruction. Give a two-minute warning.

**Mark scheme.** Spelling and grammar are not marked in reading answers if the meaning is clear. Answers copied from the text are fine when they answer the question. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

**Part A: Greenway Sports Centre** (a notice; very accessible, with pictures)

| Q | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 8:00 | 8, 8 am, eight o'clock | 7:00 (the weekday time) |
| 2 | 15 yuan | 15, ¥15 | 30 |
| 3 | People aged 16 and over | 16 and over; over 16; 16+; people who are 16 or older | "Adults" (not what the notice says); "students" |
| 4 | A 2 yuan coin | 2 yuan; a coin | "A student card" |
| 5 | a False · b True · c False | | 1 mark for each correct row (3 marks) |
| 6 | 30 yuan | 30, ¥30, 15 + 15 | 15 (one ticket); 60 (adult price) |

**Part B: Lulu Learns a Word** (fiction, about two years below age level)

| Q | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|
| 7 | green | | red (the patch on her head) |
| 8 | Hello | "Hello" in any spelling that is clear | "Oh no" (the word she learns later) |
| 9 | Fresh water and seeds | water; seeds; food; water and food | "He cleaned her cage" (that was every evening) |
| 10 | Lulu said "Oh no!" for the first time **3** · Zhang Wei did his homework next to the cage **2** · Auntie came home **4** · Auntie went away **1** | | **2 marks** for all four correct. **1 mark** if only two events next to each other in the story are swapped. |
| 11 | turned round quickly | | |
| 12 | She heard Zhang Wei say "Oh no!" again and again, and she copied him. | She copied Zhang Wei; she learnt it from Zhang Wei; Zhang Wei kept saying it when he made a mistake | "Because she was sad"; "because she made a mistake" |
| 13 | Lulu only talks when she is happy, and now she talks to Zhang Wei (she learnt a word from him), so she must be happy with him. | She learnt his words because he spent time with her; she talks to him now; she was happy with him; she said a word to him | "Because Lulu said hello" with no link to Zhang Wei; "because she is funny" |

**Part C: Sleep: why teenagers need more of it** (non-fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 12)

| Q | Skill | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 14 | Retrieval | 8 to 10 hours | between eight and ten hours | 13; "a lot" |
| 15 | Inference | Teenagers' bodies release melatonin (the chemical that makes us sleepy) later, up to two hours later. | Their body clock changes; the sleepy chemical comes later; blue light from phones tells the brain it is still daytime | "They are lazy"; "they have homework" with no link to feeling sleepy |
| 16 | Vocabulary in context | very tired | | |
| 17 | Retrieval (2) | Go to bed at about the same time every day · Put your phone in another room an hour before bed | | **1 mark for each correct tick.** Take off 1 mark for each wrong tick beyond two boxes (minimum 0). |

| Q | Skill | Answer | Also accept | Do not accept |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 18 | Inference | During deep sleep, the brain sorts and stores what we have learnt. | Sleep helps the brain save or keep information; the brain organises learning while you sleep | "Because they are not tired" with no link to memory |
| 19 | Author's purpose | To make teenage readers feel understood (it is not their fault), so they want to read on. | To get the reader's attention; to speak directly to the reader; to surprise the reader; to show it is about biology, not being lazy | "Because teenagers are lazy" |
| 20 | Author's purpose | to explain a problem and give advice | | |

**Band guide (reading paper).** Use the part scores, in this order:

| Result | Band |
|---|---|
| Part A under 4 | **A** |
| Part A 4 or more, Part B under 4 | **B** |
| Part B 4 or more, Part C under 3 | **C** |
| Part C 3 to 5 | **D** |
| Part C 6 to 8 | **E** |

Use judgement when a result is uneven (for example a high Part C with a low Part B, which can happen when a student ran out of time or misread one instruction), and check against the sentence reading screen in the interview.

**What to look for**

- Strong readers answer Part C questions 15, 18 and 19 in their own words and explain the writer's choices. Weaker readers copy a sentence near the key word whether or not it answers the question.
- Part C is a non-fiction article with subject vocabulary (melatonin, releases, developing, alert). Students from Chinese schools often know the science in Chinese; vocabulary, not the idea, is usually the barrier.
- **English barrier or reading difficulty?** If a student reads aloud fluently in the sentence reading screen but scores low here, the gap is vocabulary and comprehension, not decoding. If a student is slow and inaccurate in both, and also reads slowly in Chinese (ask the parents), note a possible reading difficulty.

## 3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task and tick it. Plan in the box first. Then write. Try to write about 20 lines. You have 10 minutes." You may repeat the instruction. Do not explain the prompts.

**The tasks**

- **Task 1 (descriptive):** describe a busy place you know well, for example a train station at Spring Festival, a night market or a sports match.
- **Task 2 (persuasive):** a speech to the class persuading students to waste less food in the school canteen.

**Marking.** Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 are between the descriptions). Total / 16. Then give the band by **best fit** with the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, using the total only as a check.

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Content and organisation** | Nothing in English, or isolated words; no link to the task. | A short response that follows the task; a list of things seen, or of reasons, with simple links ("and", "also"); little development; little paragraphing. | Well shaped for the age: the description builds a clear picture through the senses and has a focus (a moment, a mood); the speech has a clear position, two or three developed reasons with examples, a call to action and an awareness of the audience ("we", "you"); paragraphs. |

| Criterion | 0 | 2 | 4 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Vocabulary** | Single memorised words or copied words. | Everyday words used correctly; some repetition; gaps filled with simple words or Chinese. | A wide range, chosen for effect: precise nouns, verbs and adjectives in the description; persuasive language in the speech (rhetorical questions, "imagine", "surely", "every day we ..."); words for linking ideas. |
| **Grammar and sentences** | No sentences. | Simple sentences and some joined with "and", "but", "because"; frequent errors (verb tenses, plurals, articles, word order) but meaning is mostly clear. | Varied sentences, including complex ones and some for effect (a short sentence after a long one, a list of three); tenses controlled; errors are rare and do not affect meaning. |
| **Spelling and punctuation** | Spelling makes most words hard to read; no punctuation. | Common words spelt correctly; longer words phonetically plausible; full stops and capital letters used, not always correctly. | Accurate spelling, including most longer words; sentence punctuation secure; commas in lists and after openings, question and exclamation marks, apostrophes mostly correct. |

**Rough guide to the total** (best fit decides): 0 to 3 **A** · 4 to 7 **B** · 8 to 10 **C** · 11 to 13 **D** · 14 to 16 **E**.

**Band E writing at Year 8.** Comparable to a fluent writer of 12 or 13. In 10 minutes, usually 180 to 280 words in clear paragraphs. The description goes beyond a list: it uses the senses, chooses details and creates an atmosphere. The speech addresses its audience, argues with reasons and examples and ends with a clear call to action. Sentences are varied and controlled, vocabulary is precise and sometimes ambitious, and errors are few and minor. Judge quality, not just length.

**What to look for**

- Typical features of Chinese-speaking learners (missing past tense -ed or plural -s, "a" and "the", "he" and "she" mixed, "very" for every intensifier) are normal stages of learning English. Score them under grammar, but read past them to judge content.
- Memorised phrases from textbooks or exam practice ("As we all know", "In a word", "Last but not least") are common: they show learning, but judge the writing on what the student does with them.
- Writing much weaker than speaking is common in students from oral-heavy English courses; writing much stronger than speaking is common in students taught mainly through grammar and textbook dialogues.

### 3.4 Speaking and sentence reading (the interview, 15 minutes)

The interview is 1:1 and uses **`forms/Interview_Record_Y7_Y10`**. It opens with the **Graded Sentence Reading Screen** (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Record` and `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`): for Year 8, **start at Level 7 (sentence 19)**, and follow the rules on the record for going back, stopping, the meaning checks and fluency. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1. Then use the interview questions (school and learning, interests, friends and wellbeing, future plans and aspirations, values, an opinion question) and give the **speaking band** with the descriptors on the interview record. Copy the sentence reading total, reading age and the speaking band into the score summary.

The interview record's opinion questions (homework, phones) do not overlap with the writing tasks above.

## 4. Maths (20 minutes, 30 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Maths pages. Section A is number problems. Section B is word problems and problems with pictures. You cannot use a calculator. Show your working in the boxes: you can get marks for your working. I can read any question to you. Just ask. You have 20 minutes."

Read any question aloud on request, as often as asked, and point to the picture. Follow the access rules (Section 2): mark **L** if a Chinese-speaking colleague gave a question once in Chinese, and **NT** if the student says they have not learnt the topic.

**Marking.** Accept any clear, correct method. Accept equivalent answers (for example 0.375 for 3/8) unless the question says otherwise. Where units are printed on the paper, a missing unit does not lose a mark (question 11

tests units on purpose). Where a method mark is shown, give it for a correct method with one arithmetic slip.

**Section A: Number problems (10 marks)**

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | 16.15 | 1 | 12.82 means the decimal points were not lined up. | Decimals (floor item) |
| 2 | a –5 · b 24 | 1 + 1 | a: 5 or –11 are sign errors. b: –24 means the rule for two negatives is not known. | Operations with negative numbers |
| 3 | 6 | 1 | 2 or 3 are common factors but not the highest; 72 is the lowest common multiple. | HCF |
| 4 | 2 × 2 × 3 × 5 | 1 | $2^2 \times 3 \times 5$, in any order. Not 4 × 3 × 5 (4 is not prime) or 2 × 30. | Prime factorisation |
| 5 | 11/12 | 1 | 3/7 means the student added tops and bottoms. | Adding fractions |
| 6 | a $2a + 7b$ · b 7 | 1 + 1 | a: $7b + 2a$. b: 15 + (–8) = 7. 23 means b was taken as +2. | Simplifying expressions; substitution |
| 7 | $x = 5$ | 1 | | Solving a linear equation |
| 8 | $x = 4$ | 1 | $3x = 12$. 6 or 4.5 show errors in collecting terms. | Unknowns on both sides (Year 8 content: ceiling item) |

**Section B: Word problems and pictures (20 marks). W** = word problem (6 marks in all).

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 9 **W** | –11 (°C) | 1 | One-step, measures. 11, –25 or 25 show sign errors. | Negative numbers in context |
| 10 | $y = 55$, $x = 65$ (degrees) | 1 + 1 | *x*: follow through from a wrong *y*: give the mark for 120 – (their *y*). | Angles on a straight line; angles in a triangle (floor item) |
| 11 | a 68 · b 36 · units $cm^2$ for a and cm for b | 1 + 1 + 1 | a: 80 forgot the missing corner; 48 or 20 is one rectangle only. b: 29 adds only the four labelled sides (the missing sides are 3 cm and 4 cm). Units mark: both correct boxes ticked. | Area of a compound shape; perimeter; units |
| 12 **W** | Mei 45, Jun 75 (yuan) | 2 | Two-step, money. **1 mark** for 120 ÷ 8 = 15 seen, or one share correct, or both correct but the wrong way round. 40 and 80 means the ratio was read as 1 : 2 or divided by 3. | Sharing in a ratio |
| 13 **W** | 8:24 | 1 | Time. 24 minutes later; 08:24; 8.24. 8:48 is a common multiple but not the lowest. 8:14 added 6 and 8. | LCM |
| 14 | a an arrow at 1/2 · b 3/8 | 1 + 1 | a: the arrow is clearly at the middle mark. b: 0.375, 37.5%. "3 out of 8" scores but note the notation; 3 : 8 or 3 : 5 score 0. | Probability on a 0 to 1 scale |
| 15 | $a = 70$, $b = 110$ (degrees) | 1 + 1 | a: corresponding angles. b: angles on a straight line (or co-interior angles); follow through 180 – (their *a*). | Angles and parallel lines |
| 16 | 15 | 1 | 135 ÷ 360 × 40, or 135 ÷ 9 (each student is 9°). | Pie charts |
| 17 | mode 60 · median 40 · range 30 · mean 45 (minutes) | 2 | **2** for all four; **1** for two or three. Median 30 means the student did not put the values in order; range 60 is the largest value only; mean 225 is the total. | Mean, median, mode and range; bar charts |
| 18 | a 42 · b $4n + 2$ | 1 + 1 | b: $4 \times n + 2$, $2 + 4n$, "multiply by 4 and add 2". a: 60 (10 × 6) means joined sides were not taken into account. "Add 4" scores 0 in b but note it. | Sequences and the nth term (b is a ceiling item) |
| 19 **W** | 920 (yuan) | 2 | Multi-step, money and percentages. **1 mark** for 120 seen (15% of 800), or for 800 × 1.15 with an arithmetic slip. 120 as the final answer scores 1. 815 scores 0. | Percentage of an amount; percentage increase (Year 8 content: ceiling item) |

**Totals:** Section A / 10 · Section B / 20 · **of which word problems / 6** (questions 9, 12, 13 and 19).

**Band guide (maths, / 30; provisional):** 0 to 11 **1** Well below expected · 12 to 17 **2** Working towards · 18 to 25 **3** Expected · 26 to 30 **4** Greater depth. List NT questions, and judge whether the student would reach band 3 once taught.

**May not have been taught.** A Year 8 entrant from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed Grade 6 (PEP sequence; other textbooks differ a little, so ask the student). These topics are usually taught in Grade 7 (初一) or later, or are not in every textbook, so the student **may not have been taught** them:

| Questions | Topic | Usually taught in China |
|---|---|---|
| 2, 6b, 9 | Calculating with negative numbers (negative numbers are introduced in Grade 6) | Grade 7 |
| 4 | Prime factorisation as a product (primes and factors are Grade 5; the factor tree may be new) | Grade 5 in some textbooks; optional in others |
| 6 | Simplifying expressions (letters for numbers is Grade 5) | Grade 7 |
| 8 | Equations with the unknown on both sides (simple equations are Grade 5) | Grade 7 |
| 14 | Probability as a number (likelihood in words is Grade 5) | Grade 9 |
| 15 | Angle rules with parallel lines | Grade 7 |
| 17 | Median, mode and range (the mean is Grade 4) | Grade 8 |
| 18b | A rule for the nth term (pattern spotting is common) | Not taught formally |

Usually **familiar**: decimals and fractions, HCF and LCM (Grade 5), area and perimeter including compound shapes (Grades 3 to 5), angles on a straight line and in a triangle (Grade 4), ratio, percentages and pie charts (Grade 6).

**What to look for**

- **Number problems against word problems.** Compare Section A with the word problems (W). A student who does well on number problems but poorly on word problems may have an **English barrier** rather than a maths difficulty. Check by reading the word problem aloud (and, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese, marked L). If the student then solves it, record that the barrier is English. Questions 9 and 2a are a direct pair (negative numbers with and without words).
- Strong students show clear methods, use the angle facts confidently and get the ceiling items (8, 18b, 19). Students from Chinese schools often calculate quickly and accurately but write little working: that is fine when the answer is right.
- A low score that is mostly Grade 7 algebra and geometry (2, 6, 8, 15) or statistics (14, 17) is very different from a low score on taught topics (1, 3, 5, 11, 12, 16). Say which in the summary.

## 5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

**Say:** "Turn to the Science pages. There are 7 questions. Some topics may be new to you: that is fine, do what you can. I can read any question to you. You have 8 minutes." The same access rules as maths apply (L and NT). Spelling does not matter in science answers if the word is recognisable.

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | a A gas · B solid · C liquid · b It increases. | 1 + 1 | a: all three for the mark. | The particle model; energy and changes of state |
| 2 | A, B or D | 1 | The name instead of the letter (cell wall, chloroplast, vacuole). C (the nucleus) scores 0: both cells have one. | Animal and plant cells (the picture gives the comparison) |
| 3 | C 1 · A 2 · B 3 | 1 | All three for the mark: dissolve, filter, evaporate. A, C, B (filter first) shows the student has not thought about the salt being dissolved. | Separating mixtures; a method in order (working scientifically) |
| 4 | a lemon juice · b toothpaste or soap | 1 + 1 | a: vinegar is an acid but not the strongest. b: pure water is neutral. | Acids, alkalis and the pH scale; reading a table |

| Q | Answer | Marks | Accept, partial credit and common errors | Content |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 5 | a It stays the same. · b 5 (m/s) | 1 + 1 | a: "it goes down" is a very common idea (that motion needs an unbalanced force). b: 2000 means distance × time. | Balanced forces; speed = distance ÷ time |
| 6 | B | 1 | C (the most waves) means the student confused loudness with pitch. | Sound as a wave |
| 7 | C | 1 | The anther. A (the stigma) receives pollen. | Reproduction in plants |

**Band guide (science, / 10; provisional):** 0 to 3 **1** · 4 to 5 **2** · 6 to 8 **3** · 9 to 10 **4**.

**May not have been taught.** A Year 8 entrant has usually done **no secondary science**: in Chinese schools biology starts in Grade 7 (初一), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry in Grade 9. Primary science (科学) covers some of these ideas, but textbooks differ. So a Year 8 entrant **may not have been taught**: the particle model and energy in changes of state (Q1; states of matter are usually familiar from primary science), the parts of plant and animal cells (Q2; microscopes and cells are often met in Grade 6), acids, alkalis and pH (Q4; chemistry, Grade 9), balanced forces and calculating speed (Q5; physics, Grade 8), and sound shown as a wave (Q6; sound and vibration are Grade 4). Separating mixtures by filtering and evaporating (Q3) and the parts of a flower (Q7) are often taught in primary science. Read a low science score with these notes, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 2, 3, 4 and 5b.

**Not covered in this paper:** energy stores and transfers are tested only through heating and changes of state (Q1b), and light waves are not tested, because 10 marks cannot cover every Year 7 topic.

**What to look for**

- Questions 2, 3 and 4 can be answered from the picture or the table with careful reading and reasoning, even if the topic is new: a student who gets them is thinking scientifically.
- One-word answers are fine. Answers must be in English; an explanation in Chinese scores 0.

## 6. Score summary

| | |
|---|---|
| **Candidate name** | |
| **Date of assessment** | |
| **Assessor** | |

| Part | Score | Band | Notes (NT, L, access arrangements, behaviour) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Listening | / 8 | A B C D E | |
| Reading paper | / 24 (A / 8, B / 8, C / 8) | A B C D E | Where did the student stop at 12 minutes? |
| Sentence reading (shared record) | points / 72, reading age | indicative A B C D E | Meaning checks, fluency |
| Writing | / 16 (content / 4, vocabulary / 4, grammar / 4, spelling and punctuation / 4) | A B C D E | Task chosen: 1 2 |
| Speaking (from the interview) | | A B C D E | |
| Maths | / 30 (A / 10, B / 20, of which word problems / 6) | 1 2 3 4 | NT: L: |
| Science | / 10 | 1 2 3 4 | NT: L: |

**Number problems against word problems:** Section A ___ / 10 (___ %) and word problems ___ / 6 (___ %). If the word problem percentage is much lower, was the barrier English? (Tick if a word problem was solved after it was read aloud or given in Chinese.) ☐

**Overall English band:** **A** **B** **C** **D** **E** (the band most of the four skills sit in; name any skill that is two or more bands below the others)

**Comments** (strengths, gaps, NT topics, what support the student would need):

**Assessor signature and date** _____

Copy these results onto `forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`.